

2c. Content of Developments in Hindu thought (H573/07)

In this component, learners have the opportunity to undertake a systematic study of key concepts within the development of Hindu thought. Learners will explore religious beliefs, values and teachings, their interconnections, how they have developed historically and how they are presently discussed.

The foundations of Hinduism are studied within *Development and Diversity* and *Wisdom and Authority*. Learners will explore the historical development of Hinduism, and also the role of a variety of scriptures and holy persons as sources of wisdom. Through this, they will gain an understanding of the shared roots of modern Hinduism as well as the diversity of modern Hindu practice.

Learners will also consider key concepts within Hinduism, including *Brahman and the Self*, *Samsara and Karma*. Through these topics learners will gain insight into religious beliefs, values and teachings. Ideas which will be explored will include beliefs about the self and the relationship between self and Brahma, together with ideas about the meaning and purpose of human life.

In *The Concept of Dharma* learners will discuss key moral principles and their foundations, whilst in *Living in Accordance with Dharma* the ways in which these principles influence Hindu life and practice are examined.

Learners will undertake an in-depth study of Vedanta and its approach to Hindu ideas. They will explore its origins, development and a variety of forms of Vedanta, and undertake a comparison of key thinkers. This study of one of the orthodox schools of Hindu

philosophy will allow learners to engage in detailed critical analysis, and appreciate the philosophical nature of Hinduism.

In *Hinduism as 'Religion'* learners will engage with the complex status of Hinduism as a single 'religion', engaging with what this term means, its origins and criticisms of it. They will also explore the different goals of Hindu paths and critically discuss whether or not they can be viewed as one religion.

The final topics of this component place Hinduism within its social context, both in India and in the West. In the topic focusing on India learners will study the relationship between religion and society, including the influence of Hinduism on Indian identity, and ideas of religious freedom and pluralism.

In *Hinduism and the West* learners will explore the ways in which the spread of Hinduism through migration has influenced its development. They will consider the role of popular culture and famous figures such as Gandhi, demonstrating the relevance of Hinduism as an area of study and engaging students through familiar ideas.

Finally, learners will analyse Hindu responses to contemporary social issues, focusing on ideas of equality and discrimination. By examining these ideas learners will develop an insight into the ways in which cultural context impacts on religious belief and vice versa. Issues of gender and discrimination are key to today's society and so learners will again be able to appreciate the relevance of their studies to the world in which they live.

Technical Terms

While the majority of non-English terms (which are not names of texts, philosophical schools, or particular religious approaches) within the specification and assessment materials will be accompanied by a translation, there are some which are considered to be key technical terms that learners are expected to recognise and understand without a provided translation.

For this component the following are considered technical terms and will not necessarily be accompanied by a translation:

- *Adharma*
- *Brahman*

- *Dalit*
- *Devi/Shakti*
- *Dharma*
- *Karma*
- *Samsara*
- *Varna*
- *Varnasharamadharma.*

The spelling of words which have been transliterated from non-Roman alphabets will be used consistently through the assessment materials. Learners will not be penalised for the use of other common spellings.

1. Foundations

The origins and development of Hinduism, and the sources of wisdom on which it is based

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Development and Diversity*	- the Indus Valley civilisation and its connection with the origins of Hinduism - the significance of the Vedic period - the development of theistic traditions, including: - Vaishnavism - Shaivism - Shaktism	- the lack of a clear starting point of Hinduism - evidence of religion/religious practice in the Indus Valley - the development of written texts: the <i>Vedas</i> - the relationship of Vedic and modern deities - Vishnu as the supreme deity, <i>bhakti</i> (devotion) and ritual worship, moral/ethical values - Shiva as the supreme deity, <i>bhakti</i> (devotion) and ritual worship, asceticism - Devi/Shakti as the supreme principle, <i>bhakti</i> (devotion) and ritual worship (right-hand Shaktism), moral values and transgression (left-hand Shaktism/Tantra)
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the development of Hinduism and its resulting diversity, including: - the ways in which the Vedas influenced the development of Hinduism - the importance of the Vedas for Hindus today - the diversity of the different traditions and practices found within Hinduism: the focus on different deities, different world views and different paths to liberation.		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Klostermaier, K. K. (2003) <i>A Short History of Hinduism</i>, Oneworld, Chapters 3–7 - Whaling, F. (2010) <i>Understanding Hinduism</i>, Dunedin Academic Press, Chapter 2 - Doniger, W. (2010) <i>The Hindus, an Alternative History</i>, Oxford University Press, Chapters 3 and 4		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Wisdom and authority*	- the multiplicity of Hindu Scriptures - the importance and role of holy persons, including: - ascetics or mendicants (<i>Sadhus/Sadhvi</i>) - practitioners of Yoga (<i>Yogis/Yoginis</i>) - teachers (<i>Gurus</i> or <i>Swamis</i>) - renunciates (<i>Sannyasi</i>)	- the different status of <i>shruti</i> (heard) and <i>smriti</i> (remembered) texts - the role and importance of <i>smriti</i> and <i>shruti</i> texts in Hindu life, including: - the <i>Vedas</i> - the <i>Bhagavad Gita</i> - the <i>Ramayana</i> - the <i>Manusmriti</i> - dedication to religious aims, distinctive appearance - practitioner of physical, mental and/or spiritual disciplines; practices with the ultimate aim of achieving <i>moksha</i> (liberation) - spiritual teachers, transmission of spiritual traditions, <i>diksa</i> (initiation) and sharing mantras; connection with <i>ashramas</i> (stages of life) - renouncing the world, focus on liberation, connection with <i>ashrama</i> - the fact that these are not mutually exclusive terms
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to the sources of wisdom and authority in Hinduism, including: - the importance of the Vedas and other written sources of wisdom and authority for Hindus - the diversity of opinion on which texts are Shruti, including where there is general agreement (the Vedas, the Upanishads) and where there is difference (Vaishnava Samhitas, Saiva Agamas) - the importance of holy people in Hindu society, the diversity of their practice and the role as sources of wisdom and authority	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful - Klostermaier, K. K. (2000) <i>Hindu Writings – A Short Introduction to the Major Sources</i>, Oneworld, Chapters 2–4 - The Bhagavad Gita II - Flood, G.(1996) <i>An Introduction to Hinduism</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 4	

2. Insight

Beliefs, teachings and ideas about human life, the world and ultimate reality

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Brahman and the Self*	- ways of conceptualising Brahman and the existence of Brahman - the relationship of Brahman, <i>atman</i> (self) and <i>samsara</i> (cycle of birth, death and rebirth)	- to include: - being-consciousness-bliss (<i>sat-chit-ananda</i>) - not this, not this (<i>neti neti</i>) - that thou art (<i>tat tvam asi</i>) - God-consciousness-no consciousness (<i>sat-chit-achit</i>) - how these contribute to understanding the nature of Brahman and the relationship of Brahman and the self - the meaning of these terms - the concept of <i>moksha</i> - the above to be taught with reference to: - the <i>Shandilya Vidya</i>, <i>Chandogya Upanishad</i> VI.11–14, <i>Katha Upanishad</i> II <i>Bhagavad Gita</i> II.13–28
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Brahman and the self, including: - Brahman and the concept of God; considering Hinduism as monotheist, polytheist, henotheist, monist <i>moksha</i> as the ultimate aim, in relation to <i>samsara</i> and <i>karma</i>; the diversity of paths to achieving <i>moksha</i>.		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Briharanyaka Upanishad IV.4 - Ram-Prasad, C. (2005) <i>Eastern Philosophy</i>, Weidenfeld and Nicholson, Chapter 1		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Samsara and Karma*	- the cycle of birth and death (<i>samsara</i>), including: - liberation from <i>samsara</i> through surrender and grace <i>karma</i>, <i>samsara</i> and liberation, including: - aspects of <i>karma</i> <i>karma</i> in relation to <i>samsara</i>	<i>anugraha</i> (grace) and <i>prapatti</i> (taking refuge) <i>bhakti</i> and liberation; monkey and cat analogies - accumulated <i>karma</i> - fruit-bearing <i>karma</i> <i>karma</i> in the making - achieving freedom from <i>karma</i> as the means to liberation, <i>sakam karma</i> and <i>nikam karma</i> - the significance of human rebirth - the above to be taught with reference to: <i>Bhagavad Gita</i> II.47–51 and IV.14–23 <i>Chandogya Upanishad</i> VII.4 <i>Brihadaranyaka Upanishad</i> IV.4.5–6
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to <i>samsara</i> and <i>karma</i>, including: - the ways in which <i>karma</i> is played out over multiple lives - the question of positive/good <i>karma</i> and its effect on rebirth <i>karma</i> and questions of justice, free will and ethical behaviour	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful <i>Bhagavad Gita</i> IV–VI - The <i>Katha Upanishad</i> II–III - Lipner, J. (2010) <i>Hindus – Their Religious Beliefs and Practices</i>, Routledge, Chapter 12	

3. Living

The diversity of ethics and practice, including those that shape and express religious identity, the role of the community of believers and key moral principles

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
The Concept of Dharma*	<i>dharma</i> and <i>adharma</i> <i>dharma</i> in the context of righteous living	- different translations/interpretations of the term '<i>dharma</i>' - the concept of <i>dharma</i> and its importance for the world, human life and society - the concept of <i>adharma</i> and the decay and restoration of <i>dharma</i> through the <i>mahayuga</i> - the <i>purusharthas</i> (aims of life) including: - their relationship to one another - their relationship to <i>varnasharamadharma</i> - virtue/merit (<i>punya</i>) - the above to be taught with reference to: <i>Bhagavad Gita</i> IV 5–8 <i>Mahabharata Shanti Parva</i> 109.9.11 <i>Karna Parva</i> 69.58
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to <i>dharma</i> , including: <i>dharma</i> as a foundational principle of civilisation/culture (<i>sanatana dharma</i>) - the role of the Hindu community in shaping interpretations of <i>dharma</i> - the diversity of contexts in which the concept of <i>dharma</i> is applied, for example personal, societal and professional - the relationship of <i>dharma</i> to ethical living	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Whaling, F. (2010) <i>Understanding Hinduism</i>, Dunedin Academic Publishing, Chapter 7 - Flood, G. (1996) <i>An Introduction to Hinduism</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 3	

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Living in Accordance with Dharma*	<i>varnashramadharma</i> and righteous living according to traditional Hindu virtues - the virtues of: - non-violence - detachment - self-restraint	- the meaning of the term and the different concepts that make it up: <i>varna</i> (class), <i>ashrama</i> (stage of life) and <i>dharma</i> - the relationship between <i>varnashramadharma</i> and other concepts relating to how to live: the <i>purusharthas</i>, <i>karma</i> and <i>samsara</i> - details of these and their relationship with <i>dharma</i> and the other <i>purusharthas</i>. - the above to be taught with reference to: <i>Brihadaranyaka Upanishad</i>, IV.4.5–6 - the <i>Purusha Sukta</i>
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to living in accordance with <i>dharma</i>, including: - the difference between <i>varna</i> and <i>jati</i> and the impact of this on Hindu life and society - different Hindu virtues and their relationship with <i>varna</i>, <i>ashrama</i> and <i>dharma</i> - the relationship between living virtuously and achieving liberation	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful - Jacobs, S. (2010) <i>Hinduism Today</i>, Continuum, Chapter 3 - Ram-Prasad, Chakravathi (2005) <i>Eastern Philosophy</i>, Weidenfeld and Nicholson, Chapter 3	

4. Development

Significant social and historical developments in Hindu thought, such as those influenced by ethics, philosophy or studies of religion

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Vedanta	- the origins and focus of Vedanta - the significance of Vedanta for Hinduism - different schools of Vedanta: - the Advaita Vedanta of Sankara - the Vishishtadvaita Vedanta of Ramanuja - the Dvaita Vedanta of Madhva	- Vedanta as a school of philosophy; connection with the <i>upanishads</i> - Vedanta as a school of philosophy concerned with the nature of Brahman - to include Vedanta's status as the best-known form of Hindu philosophy outside India, including: - Neo-Vedanta; the importance and teachings of Vivekananda - a comparison of the different schools and thinkers of Vedanta, their similarities and differences, including approaches to and understanding of: - the relationship of Brahman and <i>atman</i>, and Brahman and the world - bondage and liberation, ways in which liberation can be achieved
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Vedanta, including: - the relationship between Vedantic philosophy and other paths to liberation, such as <i>bhakti</i> yoga - the diversity of Hindu schools of philosophy and the reasons why Vedanta is the best known - the role of moral action in Vedanta	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Flood, G. (1996) <i>An Introduction to Hinduism</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 10 - King, R. (1999) <i>Indian Philosophy</i>, Edinburgh University Press, Chapters 3 and 9 - Barnard, T. (2005 reprint) <i>Hindu Philosophy</i>, Motilal Banarsidass Publishers Private Ltd, Pages 116–128	

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Hinduism as 'Religion'	- origins of the term 'Hinduism' - criticisms of the concept of religion in relation to Hinduism	- to include: - Neo-Hinduism <i>Sadharana</i> (universal) <i>dharma</i> and <i>Sanatana</i> (eternal) <i>dharma</i> - whether 'Hinduism' exists as a single religion or a collection of different religions - the different possible goals and practices of Hinduism, including: - Hinduism as a path to liberation - Hinduism as overcoming <i>maya</i> (delusion) - Hinduism as uniting with Brahman - Hinduism as a way of life/world view
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Hinduism as 'religion', including: - the diversity of practices, beliefs and traditions that come under the title Hinduism - the Judeo-Christian history of the term 'religion' and limitations of this Western concept as it is applied to Hinduism - the academic divisions of 'religion', 'philosophy' and 'ethics' and their relevance in the context of Hinduism	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Doniger, W. (2010) <i>The Hindus, An Alternative History</i>, Oxford University Press, Introduction - Lipner, J. (2010) <i>Hindus, their Religious Beliefs and Practices</i>, Routledge, Introduction, Chapter 1 - Nye, M. (2004) <i>Religion: The Basics</i>, Routledge, Chapters 1 and 8	

5. Society

The relationship between religion and society, including issues such as how religions adapt when encountering different cultures; religious tolerance, respect and recognition and views of other religions and non-religious worldviews; religion, equality and discrimination; the political and social influence of religious institutions

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Hinduism and India	- Hinduism and India, including: - India as a holy land for Hindu traditions - Hindutva - diversity of religions in India and attitudes of Hindus towards these - religion and the law	- the relationship between Hinduism and Indian geography and history 'Hindu-ness' as a cultural and political identity; the caste system (<i>jati</i>) and non-Hindus; secularism and secularisation in India - India as a secular state, religious equality laws, the reality of religious diversity - scheduled castes and family law
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Hinduism and India, including: - the historic prohibition on travel outside of India for Brahmins, and the implications of this for Western understanding - possible tensions between religions that originated in India (and share the Hindu world view) and those that did not - Hindu attempts to reform Hinduism	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Jacobs, S. (2010) <i>Hinduism Today</i>, Continuum, Chapter 3 - Smith, D. (2003) <i>Hinduism and Modernity</i>, Blackwell Publishing, Chapter 12 - Klostermaier, K. K. (2003) <i>A Short History of Hinduism</i>, OneWorld, Chapter 10	

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Hinduism and the West	- Western understandings of Hinduism and being a Hindu in the West, including; - Hinduism outside India	- Hindu communities outside India and how these develop, for example due to migration - non-Hindu perceptions of Hinduism and the impact of the portrayal of Hinduism in popular culture - practising Hindu religion within different cultures, including: - interreligious relationships - responses to Western philosophy and science
	practising traditional Hinduism outside India and in a non-Hindu society	<i>varna</i> and <i>ashrama</i> in relation to society and social values (<i>varnashramadharma</i>) - traditions affected by legal/cultural concerns, for example funeral traditions, festivals and pilgrimage
	influence of Vivekananda, Ramakrishna and Gandhi	social and political importance, work on Hindu reform, spiritual teachings
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Hinduism in the West, including: - issues arising from stereotyping and overly simplistic understandings of Hinduism - the impact of Gandhi on the non-Hindu world, and Hindu attitudes to him as the best known representative of Hinduism - changes and reforms within Hinduism as a result of Western influences and contact with other religions	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful - Flood, G. (1996) <i>An Introduction to Hinduism</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 11 - Smith, D. (2003) <i>Hinduism and Modernity</i>, Blackwell Publishing, Chapter 11 - Jacobs, S. (2010) <i>Hinduism Today</i>, Continuum, Chapter 5	

6. Challenges

Challenges facing religious thought from areas such as science, secularisation, migration and multi-cultural societies and changing gender roles

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Hinduism, Equality and Discrimination	- Hindu understandings of issues relating to equality and discrimination, including: <i>dalits</i> and the issue of untouchability - the traditional roles of men and women in Hinduism	- to include: - Brahminism and Hindu society, the difference between <i>varna</i> and <i>jati</i> (caste) - the issue of <i>dalit</i> voices; whether they can speak for themselves or must rely on others to speak for them - social issues arising from the concept of untouchability - to include: <i>stridharma</i> and the importance of marriage and children - sons and daughters; duties, dowries, traditional value placed on sons - social issues arising from these views
Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Hinduism, equality and discrimination, including: - the relationships and interconnections between religious teaching and practice and social/cultural tradition - the ways in which social issues arise from religious and cultural traditions and the change in attitudes over time - the influence of cultural contexts, including Western culture, on Hinduism and Hindu beliefs about equality and discrimination.		
Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Flood, G. (1996) <i>An Introduction to Hinduism</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 11 - Klostermaier, K. K. (2000) <i>Hinduism – A Short Introduction</i>, OneWorld, Chapters 15–16 - Jacobs, S. (2010) <i>Hinduism Today</i>, Continuum, Chapter 3		

Topic	Content	Key Knowledge
Hinduism and Social Reform	- attempts at reform, including: - feminism and womens' movements <i>dalit</i> movements and networks	- culture-specific concerns, including <i>sati</i> and the rights of widows and daughters - the education of women - caste and the feminist movement - religious and cultural attitudes towards the concept of untouchability <i>dalit</i> education - Dalit Solidarity Networks
	Learners should have the opportunity to discuss issues related to Hinduism and social issues, including: - the issue of who speaks on behalf of discriminated minorities and how best to create change - questions about whether or not entrenched social issues can be tackled through religious and other means, and what these means might be - questions about what is part of religious teaching and what is a matter of interpretation, custom or wider culture	
	Suggested scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority <i>Learners will be given credit for referring to any appropriate scholarly views, academic approaches and sources of wisdom and authority, however the following examples may prove useful</i> - Flood, G. (1996) <i>An Introduction to Hinduism</i>, Cambridge University Press, Chapter 11 - Sharma, A. and Young, K. K. (eds) (1999) <i>Feminism and World Religions</i>, State University of New York Press, Chapter 1 - Smith, D. (2003) <i>Hinduism and Modernity</i>, Blackwell Publishing, Chapter 12	